



WOOLF CONSULTING · OPERATOR PLAYBOOK

The Demo Runbook

Everything you need to run a free 30-minute consulting demo that converts into a paying client. The script, the structure, the verbal close, and the things you must never do.

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FOR: NEAL WOOLF, STEVEN WOOLF

TIER 1 — OPERATORS ONLY



01. The Frame

Every free demo has exactly one mission: produce one moment where the prospect sees something they couldn't have done themselves. That moment is the entire ballgame. Engineer the 30 minutes to deliver it.

Why this works on cold prospects

Older, monied prospects have heard pitches their whole career and developed antibodies to them. The free demo bypasses the antibodies because you stop *telling* and start *showing*. They don't have to trust your judgment — they get to watch it happen in real time and judge it themselves.

The three levers that produce "the moment"

1. **Speed compression.** Do in 3 minutes what would have taken them 3 hours. Visceral. They feel the time difference in their gut.
2. **Quality jump.** Produce something at a quality level they couldn't have reached on their own. Subjective but powerful when it lands.
3. **Synthesis they couldn't have made.** Connect two pieces of their world they hadn't connected. The "oh shit, I never saw that" insight. **This is the moat.**

Default to lever #3. Speed and quality can be replicated by them on their own time once they know what's possible. Synthesis can't, because it requires someone who can see their *whole board* from the outside. That's what Woolf uniquely offers — sales, tech, story, and operations under one brain.

The frame in one sentence

USE THIS FRAME OPENING ANY DEMO

"30 minutes with us isn't about teaching you AI. It's about us looking at your whole situation from the outside and showing you one connection you hadn't made. If we don't, you don't owe us a thing."



02. The 30-Minute Structure

Four phases. Each one has a specific job. Don't skip phases. Don't rearrange them.



BOX SCORE · THE 30-MINUTE GAME

PHASE	TIME	JOB
01	0–5 min	Discovery — make them articulate the problem out loud
02	5–20 min	Live Demo — solve a piece of THEIR real problem in front of them
03	20–25 min	The Reveal — anchor against their billable rate, name the synthesis
04	25–30 min	The Single Ask — one more session, lock in the time, charge the card

Two non-negotiable rules

- **No slides. Ever.** The moment you share a slide deck, you become every other consultant they've blown off. Live work or nothing.
- **No discussion of methodology.** They don't care HOW the brain works, they care WHAT it can do for them. Show outputs, not process.

Tools to have open BEFORE every call

- Claude.ai (logged in, ready) — for the live work
- A blank Google Doc (for capturing what you find, sharing screen)
- The prospect's qualification form responses (re-read in the 5 min before the call)
- This runbook (open on a second monitor)
- Their company website / LinkedIn (open in a tab, for live research moves)



03. Phase 1 — Discovery (0–5 min)

Job: get them to articulate the problem out loud, in their own words, to a stranger. The act of saying it crystallizes how stuck they feel — and that crystallization is what makes the demo land later.

The 4 questions to ask, in order

1. **"Walk me through what you put on the form — just so I'm hearing it from you."** Forces them to repeat it verbally. The verbal version is always more honest than the written one.
2. **"What does this cost you when it's not working?"** Anchors against their pain in their own currency — money, time, sleep, customer churn. You'll use this number again in The Reveal.
3. **"What have you already tried, and what specifically didn't work about it?"** Tells you what NOT to demo (don't waste time showing them something they've already seen).
4. **"If you and I were having this same call six months from now and you were thrilled, what would have changed?"** The future-self anchor. Now you know what success looks like in their words.

✓ GREEN FLAGS

- Specific, concrete problem
- Has tried things and can name them
- Knows the cost of inaction
- Has decision authority
- Asks "how much" before you bring it up

✗ RED FLAGS

- Vague problem ("AI in general")
- Hasn't tried anything
- Doesn't know the cost
- "Need to check with my partner"
- Already negotiating before the demo

If you see 3+ red flags in the first 5 minutes, finish the demo politely but skip the Single Ask. They're not going to convert and pushing the close will damage your reputation. Just deliver value, end the call cleanly, and don't follow up.



04. Phase 2 — The Live Demo (5–20 min)

Job: pull a real piece of their problem and solve it live, in front of them, in 15 minutes. No slides. No "in general." Their actual world, their actual document, their actual decision.

How to find the live problem fast

By minute 5 you know roughly what they're stuck on. Pick the smallest piece you can solve in ~12 minutes that would *visibly* move the needle. Examples:

- They're an attorney drowning in contract review → ask them to share one contract, summarize the risk surface, flag the three things that should change.
- They're a founder with a stalled launch → ask them for the one document blocking the launch, restructure it as a spec, identify the missing decision.
- They're a sales operator with a dying pipeline → ask them for one prospect's emails, draft the next message that would actually get a reply.
- They're an investor tracking too many companies → ask them for last week's update emails, synthesize the three patterns across them.

The "show don't tell" rule

While the work is happening, narrate **what you're noticing**, not what you're doing. "I'm noticing this contract has a termination clause that conflicts with section 8..." reads as expertise. "Now I'm going to feed this into Claude..." reads as a technical demo.

If the demo goes sideways

- **The output is wrong.** Acknowledge it, fix it on the fly, frame the correction as part of the value: "this is exactly why you want a human in the loop, not a tool you have to trust blindly."
- **The problem is too big for 15 min.** Carve off the smallest concrete sub-problem and solve THAT completely. A perfect tiny win beats a half-finished big one.
- **The prospect goes silent.** They're processing. Don't fill the silence. Let them think.
- **The prospect asks "how does this work?"** Redirect: "I'll show you in a minute — let me finish this part first." Process questions kill momentum.



05. Phase 3 — The Reveal (20–25 min)

Job: name what just happened in their language. Anchor it against their billable rate or their pain cost. Make the math obvious without rubbing their nose in it.

The reveal script — three sentences

USE THIS VERBATIM, ADAPTED TO THEIR NUMBERS

"What you just watched took us about [4] minutes. If you'd done that yourself or had your associate do it, my honest estimate is [3–4 hours]."

"You told me earlier that an hour of your time is worth roughly [\$X]. So we just delivered [\$Y] of work in 4 minutes."

"The reason it works isn't the AI — that part you already knew about. It's the synthesis: I was able to look at your problem from the outside and see [the specific connection you found]. That's what we sell."

What you're doing in this phase, mechanically

- **Anchor flip.** The price you're about to name (\$299) needs to feel small next to the value just demonstrated. Their billable rate is the anchor, not your hourly rate.
- **Naming the synthesis.** Even if you used speed/quality during the demo, the *reveal* should always credit synthesis. That's the moat. That's what they'll remember.
- **Ego-friendly framing.** Never say "you couldn't have done this." Say "the angle I had on it was different from inside your day-to-day." They need to feel smart for hiring you, not dumb for not doing it themselves.

The bridge into Phase 4

End the reveal with a single transition sentence that points at the next session, not the price:

BRIDGE SENTENCE

"If we did one more session like this, the obvious next move would be [the bigger version of what we just did]. Want me to show you what that would look like?"

This is a yes/no question. They will say yes. Now you're in Phase 4 with momentum.



06. Phase 4 — The Single Ask (25–30 min)

Job: ask for one specific commitment, charge the card during the call, and end on time. Do not pitch a retainer. Do not offer "let me send some materials." One ask, one answer.

The single-ask script

AFTER THE BRIDGE SENTENCE, WHEN THEY SAY "YES, SHOW ME"

"Here's what I'd do. The thing I think you actually need is a Late Night — one evening, three hours, after work, where we go deep on this. Not a regular call. An immersive session. We'd walk through three scenarios for [your situation] and you'd have a written one-page strategic memo from me the next morning."

"It's \$599. But because you came through the demo today, I can do something I don't normally do: I'll honor the intro rate of \$499 if we book it within the next 7 days."

"I have Thursday or Saturday evening this week — which works better for you?"

What that script is doing, mechanically

- **Names the standard rate first.** \$299 is the anchor. Without it, the discount has nothing to discount from.
- **Frames the discount as a personal favor** ("something I don't usually do"). Reciprocity. They feel chosen.
- **7-day expiration, said out loud.** Real urgency, not artificial. They have a week to think but they have to commit before the week is up.
- **Closes with a calendar question, not a price question.** If they're picking a day, they've already said yes to the price. This is the most important pattern in the whole script.

If they want the smaller or bigger version

If they want something smaller, offer The Spark (\$249 → \$199 intro). If they want something bigger or have a real fork in the road, offer The War Room (\$1,499 → \$1,249 intro). Default to The Late Night unless they explicitly point another direction.

If they say "let me think about it"

DON'T FIGHT IT. REFRAME IT AS A SMALLER COMMITMENT.

"Totally fair. The intro rates are good for 7 days from today — that's [date]. If you decide before then, just reply to my email and I'll send a calendar invite. After that, the rates go back to standard."

You've planted urgency without applying pressure. Most "let me think about it"s that close, close in the first 48 hours after the demo while the value is still warm.



07. The Verbal Intro Stack — Verbatim Script

These prices are NEVER on the website. They are a one-time, in-conversation gift you offer to prospects who took the demo and are showing buying signals. The fact that they're verbal-only is what makes them feel personal.

The discount table

TIER	FORMAT	PUBLIC	INTRO	WINDOW
The Spark	60 min · one problem	\$249	\$199	7 days
The Late Night ★	3 hrs · one evening · memo	\$599	\$499	7 days
The War Room	2 Late Nights · 2 weeks · 5-page memo	\$1,499	\$1,249	7 days

The default offer is always The Late Night

- **The Late Night is the signature product.** Three hours, after work, immersive, with a written memo within 24 hours. Most prospects fit here. It's the obvious yes.
- **Offer The Spark only if** they have a single concrete question, are budget-constrained, or seem hesitant about the commitment. The Spark is the consolation prize, not the lead offer.
- **Offer The War Room only if** (a) they have a real fork in the road (launch, fundraiser, pivot, hire), OR (b) the demo revealed a problem too big for one Late Night, OR (c) they explicitly said "I need ongoing help, not a one-off."
- **Never offer all three with equal weight.** Lead with The Late Night. Mention the others only if asked.

The Late Night offer — exact words

AFTER THEY SIGNAL INTEREST IN "MORE THAN ONE SESSION"

"What you actually want is a Late Night. It's a three-hour evening session — 7 to 10pm Central — where we go deep on your situation, walk through three strategic scenarios, and I send you a one-page memo by the next morning. Normally \$599. Because you came through the demo today, I can do \$499 if we lock it in this week. Most people tell me afterwards that one Late Night replaced about 20 hours of their own thinking. I have Thursday or Saturday open this week — which one works?"

The 'never' rules for the verbal stack

- **Never extend the 7-day window.** Once you do it once, every prospect will ask for an extension and the urgency dies. The window is a hard wall.
- **Never offer the discount BEFORE the demo.** Without the demo, the discount is meaningless. With the demo, it feels like a gift.
- **Never write the discount math in an email.** Verbal only on the live call. Written discounts feel transactional. Spoken discounts feel personal.
- **Never apologize for the price.** If you flinch, they flinch.



08. After The Call — The 60-Minute Rule

Within 60 minutes of ending a demo, send the prospect the Post-Demo Follow-Up PDF while the value of the demo is still warm in their head. After 24 hours the impression decays exponentially. After 72 hours it's gone.

The 60-minute follow-up email — template

SEND WITHIN 60 MINUTES. PERSONALIZE THE [BRACKETED] PARTS.

Subject: *Following up on our 30 minutes — [their name]*

Hi [Name],

Quick follow-up while it's still fresh. The piece I noticed in our session that I think actually matters most is [the specific synthesis from the Reveal]. Attached is a one-pager that recaps what we covered and lays out the three options I mentioned at the end — including the intro rate that's good through [date 7 days from now].

If The Late Night is the one that fits, just reply with "Late Night" and I'll send a calendar invite + payment link tonight. If you'd rather start with The Spark, reply with "Spark" and we'll book a time. If now's not the right moment, no pressure — but the intro rate expires Tuesday.

Either way, thanks for the 30 minutes.

— Neal

The follow-up cadence (if they don't reply within 24 hours)

- **Day 2 (48 hrs after demo):** One-line nudge. "Hey [name], any read on the options I sent yesterday? Happy to answer questions either way."
- **Day 5 (intro rate expires in 2 days):** Reminder email. "Quick note — the intro rate expires Tuesday. After that we're back to standard pricing. No pressure if it's not the right moment."
- **Day 8 (intro rate expired):** Closing email. "The intro window closed yesterday — the offer's now back to standard \$299/hour. The door's open whenever you're ready, no expiration on that part."
- **Day 30:** One last check-in if they were a strong demo. "Hey [name], been a month — did the [specific problem] get sorted? Happy to revisit if not."
- **After day 30:** Drop them. They're not converting right now. Move on.



09. Things to Never Do

These are the rules that, if broken, will cost you the conversion every time. Not most of the time — every time.

⚠ THE HARD NEVERS

- **NEVER** show slides during a demo. The moment you share a deck, you become every other consultant.
- **NEVER** pitch a retainer in the first call. The single ask is for ONE more session, period.
- **NEVER** apologize for the price or offer to lower it on the fly. The price is the price. The verbal stack is a planned gift, not a negotiation.
- **NEVER** let "let me check with my partner" become a multi-week stall. Reframe immediately: "Of course — the intro rate is good through [date], so just let me know by then."
- **NEVER** extend the 7-day intro window for anyone. Doing it once kills the mechanic for every future prospect.
- **NEVER** follow up more than 4 times. The cadence on page 9 is the maximum. After that you're harassing.
- **NEVER** give the demo to someone who couldn't fill out 3 sentences on the qualification form. They're not serious.
- **NEVER** do a demo without the qualification form responses in front of you. You'll waste the first 10 minutes re-discovering what they already wrote.
- **NEVER** use the word "AI" more than twice in a demo. Show outputs, not technology.
- **NEVER** end a demo without asking for the next step. Even a "no" is better than a "they'll get back to me."

The two soft nevers

- **Avoid** demos before 9am or after 8pm Central. Tired prospects don't buy. Tired Neal doesn't sell.
- **Avoid** back-to-back demos without a 30-minute gap. The 60-minute follow-up email needs to happen while the demo is still fresh in YOUR head, not just theirs.



10. Quick Reference Card

Print this page. Stick it on the wall next to your monitor. Glance at it during every demo until it's muscle memory.

The 30-Minute Game Plan

0–5 min · **DISCOVERY** — 4 questions, listen for cost-of-pain

5–20 min · **LIVE DEMO** — solve a piece of THEIR real problem, no slides

20–25 min · **THE REVEAL** — anchor against their billable rate

25–30 min · **THE SINGLE ASK** — one more session, \$249 intro, 7-day window

THE FRAME (OPEN EVERY DEMO WITH THIS)

"30 minutes with us isn't about teaching you AI. It's about us looking at your whole situation from the outside and showing you one connection you hadn't made. If we don't, you don't owe us a thing."

THE VERBAL INTRO STACK

Spark \$249 → **\$199** · Late Night \$599 → **\$499** · War Room \$1,499 → **\$1,249**

7-day window. Verbal only. Never written, never extended.

THE SINGLE ASK (VERBATIM — DEFAULT = LATE NIGHT)

"What you actually want is a Late Night — three hours, one evening, 7 to 10 Central, immersive, written memo by morning. Normally \$599. Intro rate is \$499 if we book this week. I have Thursday or Saturday open — which one?"

IF THEY HESITATE

"Totally fair. The intro rates are good for 7 days from today. If you decide before then, just reply to my email."

THE HARD NEVERS

No slides. No retainer pitch. No price apologies. No discount extensions. No demos without the form filled out.

